



tmix^w — playtest guide

v0.8.4 inner candidate · private · voice-first · looks like a book, not a chat app

Thanks for trying this. tmix^w is a voice-first AI storytelling game that runs **entirely on your own machine** — you talk, a narrator talks back (in text), and the game quietly keeps track of your story: characters you meet, quests you pick up, places you go. Nothing is sent to the cloud. No account, no subscription, no telemetry.

This is casual playtesting — **just play it like a game**. There is no test script. Play a few evenings, poke at whatever interests you, and tell me what delighted you, confused you, or broke.

What you need

- ◆ **Windows 10 or 11**, 64-bit
- ◆ A **GPU with ~6 GB+ VRAM** (or 16 GB system RAM for CPU-only — slower but works)
- ◆ A **microphone** (any headset or laptop mic is fine — you can also just type)
- ◆ Roughly **6-10 GB of disk** for the AI models
- ◆ ~20 minutes for first-time setup

Two downloads to grab first

The installer sets up almost everything, but two pieces are yours to bring (they're how the game stays private — the AI runs locally, under your control):

1. **KoboldCPP** — the local AI engine. Download the single .exe for your GPU from <https://github.com/LostRuins/koboldcpp/releases> (for NVIDIA cards take koboldcpp.exe; the page explains the variants). No install — just save it somewhere you'll remember.
2. A **language model** (the “brain”, ~4.4 GB). Recommended: **Mistral-7B-Instruct-v0.3, Q4_K_M** — from huggingface.co/bartowski/Mistral-7B-Instruct-v0.3-GGUF, download Mistral-7B-Instruct-v0.3-Q4_K_M.gguf. Save it next to KoboldCPP.

You'll also be asked for **whisper-cli** (speech recognition). If the wizard doesn't find one, grab the latest Windows zip from github.com/ggerganov/whisper.cpp/releases, extract it, and point the wizard at whisper-cli.exe.

Installing

1. Run **tmixw Setup 0.8.4.exe**. Windows SmartScreen will warn you because the app isn't code-signed yet — click **More info** → **Run anyway**. (Signing is coming; for now you have my word and the source.)
2. The first-run wizard walks you through the rest, in order: **FFmpeg** (auto-detected or auto-downloaded), **speech recognition** (point it at whisper-cli.exe if asked, then pick a model size — **Small** is a good default; Medium hears better but downloads ~1.5 GB), **microphone** (pick yours and test it — you'll hear a 2-second playback), **KoboldCPP** (browse to the .exe you downloaded), **language model** (browse to the .gguf), and an

optional **Player Agent** toggle (experimental — fine to skip).

3. When the wizard finishes, the game boots the AI and drops you into the story screen. First model load can take a minute.

How to play

- ◆ **Hold the backtick key (`)** — top-left, under Esc — **and speak**. Release it and your words are transcribed and sent. The narrator's reply streams in like prose in a book.
- ◆ Don't like talking? **Type instead** — same box, same story.
- ◆ Say what you do, ask what you see, talk to people. It's improv with a narrator who never gets tired. There's no win condition — it's a campaign, and it remembers. Quit whenever; your story picks up where you left off.
- ◆ **The Codex** (left panel — STORY / CAST / WORLD) fills itself in as you play. When the AI adds someone new you'll see a small “◆ added to Cast” chip and a gold-bordered card. You don't have to do anything — but **everything in the Codex is yours to edit**: click any field to rewrite it, keep or rewrite new entries, drag things into groups you make. The AI fills in lore; you always get the last word.
- ◆ **■ Stop** interrupts the narrator mid-stream if a reply is going somewhere you don't want; then redo, continue, or rewrite it.
- ◆ **Settings** (gear) has narration style presets, length, backgrounds per location, and the push-to-talk key if backtick doesn't suit you.

What I'm hoping you'll do

Play **2-3 sessions of an hour or so**, ideally on different days (the game's long-term memory across restarts is one of the things being proven out). Then tell me, on Discord, whatever stands out — a few honest sentences beat a formal report. Things I especially care about:

- ◆ Anywhere you felt **confused or stuck** (especially during setup)
- ◆ The narrator **forgetting or contradicting** something that happened earlier
- ◆ Anything that **interrupted play** when you didn't ask for it
- ◆ Moments that just **felt good** — those matter as much as the bugs

If something breaks

DM me on Discord with what you were doing, what happened, and a screenshot if it's visual. If a crash or weirdness repeats, do this once:

1. Open %AppData%\Roaming\tmixw\core\config.json in Notepad, change "debug": false to "debug": true, save, restart the game.
2. Reproduce the problem, then send me %AppData%\Roaming\tmixw\main.log along with your description.

Your story lives in %AppData%\Roaming\tmixw\core\world_state.json — if the story data itself goes weird, send that file too.

Known quirks (no need to report these)

- ◆ If you **rename** a character in the Codex and the narrator mentions their old name later, a duplicate “new” card can appear. Just delete it — and do tell me how often this bites you; that I do want to know.
- ◆ Very occasionally a reply stalls for a beat and restarts — that's an automatic retry, not a crash.
- ◆ The first reply after launching is slower than the rest (model warm-up).

Thanks for playing. The whole point of this thing is the feeling of a story that's truly yours, on your own machine — you're the first people outside the dev box to try it.